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MySQL NULL Functions

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MySQL COALESCE() and IFNULL() Functions

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Operations involving NULL values can sometimes lead to unexpected results.

MySQL has two built-in functions to handle NULL values:

- `COALESCE()`
- `IFNULL()`

A `NULL` value represents an unknown or missing data in a database field. It is not a value itself, but a placeholder to indicate the absence of data.

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PId	ProductName	Price	InStock	InOrder
1	Jarlsberg	10.45	16	15
2	Mascarpone	32.56	23	*null*
3	Gorgonzola	15.67	9	20

The "InOrder" column is optional, and may contain NULL values.

Now look at the following SQL statement:

```
SELECT ProductName, Price * (InStock + InOrder)
FROM Products;
```

Note: In the SQL above, if any of the "InOrder" values are NULL, the result will be NULL!

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The `COALESCE()` function is the preferred standard for handling potential NULL values.

The `COALESCE()` function returns the first non-NULL value in a list of values.

Syntax

```
COALESCE(val1, val2, ...., val_n)
```

Here we use the `COALESCE()` function to replace NULL values with 0:

```
SELECT ProductName, Price * (InStock + COALESCE(InOrder, 0))
FROM Products;
```

MySQL IFNULL() Function

The `IFNULL()` function function replaces NULL with a specified value.

Syntax

```
IFNULL(expr, alt)
```

Here we replace NULL values with 0:

```
SELECT ProductName, Price * (InStock + IFNULL(InOrder, 0))
FROM Products;
```

Which function in MySQL is used to handle `NULL` values by providing an alternative value?

- NULL()
- ISNULL()
- IFNULL()
- NVL()

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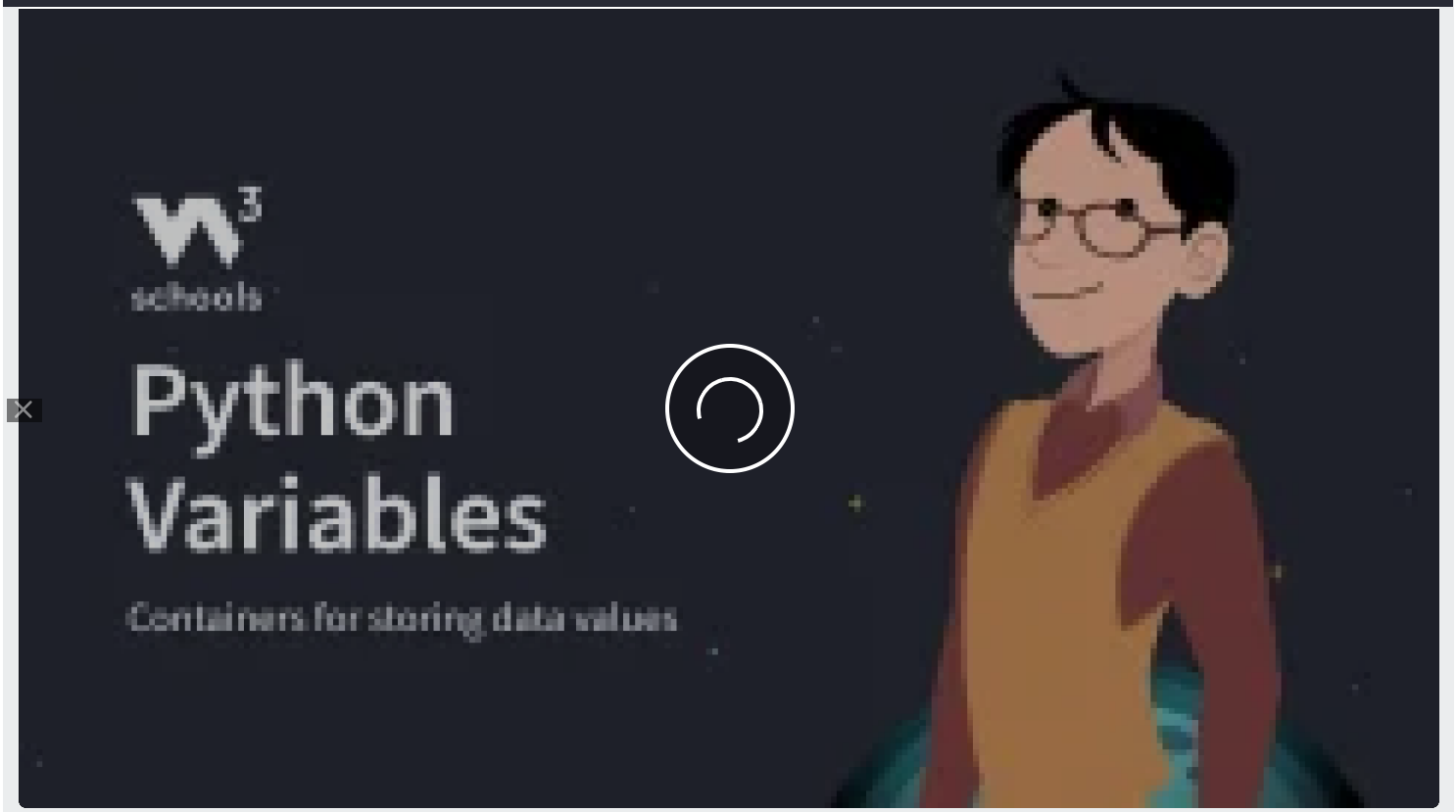
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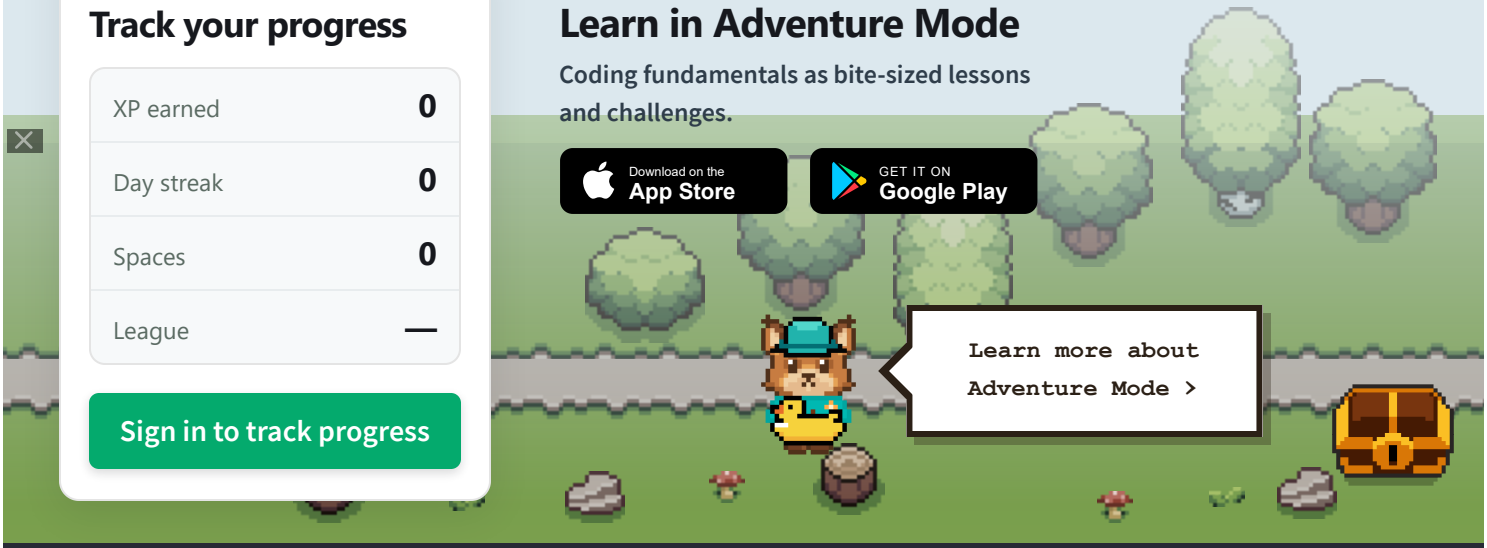
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